

Cognizant

Cognizant Ace Team Off-campus hiring 2026 - Full-Stack AI Engineer (Associate and Senior Associate grade)



Job Profile Details

Placement Cycle

Job Location

Date of Visit

Position Type

Expected Hires

Sector

CTC

Superset Placements

Pan India

NA

Full Time

NA

Information Technology

INR 1200000 - 1800000

CTC Additional Info

Compensation Details:

Grade:

Associate - 12 LPA

Senior Associate - 18 LPA

Category

Level 1 - Superset Jobs

Description

About the role:

Cognizant Ace Team is Cognizant's most selective engineering program, a handpicked cohort of highpotential AI builders chosen to work on real client challenges using AI-native tools, modern architectures, and outcome-driven methods. As an Ace Full Stack AI Engineer, you will be part of a small, high-caliber team deployed on focused, high-impact engagements across clients and industries. From the very start, you will work on production codebases, build AI-native capabilities such as retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) pipelines, agentic workflows, and LLM-integrated applications, and present working solutions to client stakeholders.

Through structured rotations across domains, technology stacks, and problem types, the program enables you to rapidly build both depth and breadth of experience, developing, within a short span, a portfolio of solved problems that traditionally takes 5+ years to accumulate.

Areas of responsibility

Area

What you will do

AI - Native Engineering

Build UI components, REST APIs, and end-to-end workflows leveraging LLMs,

Solution design & architecture	code assistants and AI agents
	Design prompt templates, structured outputs, and tool-calling patterns for production use
	Engineer AI-first workflows: RAG pipelines, agentic systems, and tool orchestration
	Integrate fine-tuned or hosted AI models into enterprise application stacks
	Rapidly absorb unfamiliar client codebases, team contexts, and problem spaces within days
Quality & governance	Translate business requirements into AI-native solution designs with clear API and data-flow specifications
	Make informed decisions on model selection, RAG vs agentic approaches, and cost-accuracy trade-offs
	Contribute to architecture discussions; document technical trade-offs and assumptions
	Validate AI outputs for correctness, safety, and relevance; flag hallucinations and bias early
	Design and run continuous test automation for AI-enabled features
Delivery & client impact	Implement monitoring, logging, and AI guardrails to support auditability
	Follow and promote secure-by-design and responsible AI practices
	Ship working AI-native features and production-grade systems at accelerated pace
Communication & collaboration	Deliver short-cycle POCs, prototypes, and live client demos
	Produce handover documentation so client teams can sustain and scale independently
	Communicate technical concepts clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders
	Lead demos, technical walkthroughs, and client-facing showcases
Collaborate across cross-functional teams; mentor peers on engagements	

Skills & technologies

Category	Technologies & Skills
Languages & Frameworks	Python, Java / .NET, JavaScript / TypeScript
AI & LLM	LLMs & Embeddings, RAG pipelines, Prompt engineering, LLM orchestration (LangChain / LangGraph)

	assistants (GitHub Copilot, Claude)
Cloud & DevOps	AWS / Azure / GCP, Git, CI/CD pipelines, etc.
AI Evaluation & Ops	AI quality metrics, Monitoring & guardrails and degradation strategies
Good to Have	Vector DB concepts, Streamlit / FastAPI, Event-driven architectures

Additional skills

- Students graduating in 2026 with B.E/B. Tech/M.E/M. Tech degrees from IITs, NITs, IIITs, BITs. Relevant experience in AI-enabled full stack development will be preferred.
- Demonstrated excellence in CS fundamentals and AI/ML projects - through academic work, open-source contributions, hackathons, or personal builds.
- Strong portfolio of AI-enabled or full-stack development projects (academic or personal).
- Genuine curiosity for AI tools, agents, and the future of software engineering.

Why Ace Team ?

- Client-site deployment from week one -visible impact on live enterprise problems, not a back-office bench role.
- Real AI-native products - build RAG systems, agentic workflows, and LLM-integrated applications on production data.
- Cognizants AI toolchain & global network - access to cutting-edge platforms and a community of elite engineers across 40+ countries.
- AI-augmented productivity targets - ship at 2x velocity using AI coding assistants, building elite engineering habits from day one.
- Mentorship from senior architects - learn on live transformation programmes, not classroom simulations.
- Clear growth pathway - defined progression into specialist, principal, and architect tracks.

Mandatory documents for registration:

Registration link will be shared with college placement officers and students must scan and upload the below mentioned documents while registering:

- Resume (maximum of 2 pages) with a high-resolution passport size photograph. Please note that the recent photograph should be clicked in a light background and both the ears of the candidates must be visible.

Mandatory documents for interview:

- All academic documents including the college ID card (if available), school / college, UG and PG marksheets, provisional/ degree certificate.

Mandatory documents for onboarding:

- The final Cognizant onboarding would be subject to satisfactory background verification.
- PAN card - If PAN card is not available, please apply for it. It is a mandatory requirement for onboarding. Please ensure that your last name, father's name, and other details are accurate. Please note that background verification will fail if the last name is not updated or if the PAN card name does not match the registered name.
- Voter ID card / Passport will be mandatory to verify citizenship.
- Aadhar card is mandatory for onboarding.

Note: All shortlisted candidates will be notified on the hiring grade level for interview. Final decision on candidate screening, eligibility for assessments, interview and final selection will be at the sole discretion of Cognizant.

Disclaimer:

- Cognizant does not entertain payments of any kind from candidates or vendors for employment. Requests for such payments should be promptly reported to GenCHRCComplianceIND@cognizant.com
- If you encounter anyone who claims to offer jobs at Cognizant in return for any benefit (monetary or non-monetary), please do not entertain them. Please be informed that Cognizant shall not be held responsible for any such instances or payments you make
- We recommend that you do not respond to spam emails/ messages you do not trust; never disclose your personal or financial details to anyone you do not know. If any such mails purporting to come from Cognizant are received, we advise you to contact us at GenCHRCComplianceIND@cognizant.com
- Cognizant takes its hiring practices seriously and appreciates you keeping the Company informed of any individuals posing as Cognizant employees who make false job offers using Cognizant's name. We remind you that while recruiting employees, Cognizant will only communicate with you through authentic Cognizant email addresses and Cognizant will never extend any job offers to anyone based on an online application without first conducting an in-person, video, or telephone interview through verified encrypted channels
- To ascertain that you are receiving a genuine call from Cognizant, please ensure to collect the recruiters

details (full name; official email id, employee ID & mobile number) during the call

Open for Courses

- Indian Institute of Information Technology Design and Manufacturing Kancheepuram

M.Tech.

1. Computer Science and Engineering (Data Science and Artificial Intelligence)
2. Electronics and Communication Engineering (Communication Systems)
3. Electronics and Communication Engineering (Microelectronics and VLSI Systems)
4. Mechanical Engineering (Mechanical Systems Design)
5. Mechanical Engineering (Smart Manufacturing)

B.Tech

1. Computer Science and Engineering
2. Electronics and Communication Engineering
3. Mechanical Engineering
4. Smart Manufacturing
5. Computer Science Engineering (Major in Artificial Intelligence)
6. Computer Science Engineering (Major in Artificial Intelligence)

Eligibility Criteria

M.Tech.	Applicants must have obtained 60 % in Class 10th 60 % in Post Graduate 60 % in Industrial Training Institute (ITI) 60 % in Diploma 60 % in Class 12th 60 % in Undergraduate
	Applicants must have obtained 60 % in Undergraduate 60 % in Diploma 60 % in Industrial Training Institute (ITI) 60 % in Class 10th 60 % in Class 12th 60 % in Post Graduate
B.Tech	
Work Experience Criteria	No work experience based criteria defined yet!
Allowed Genders	[Y] Male students [Y] Female students [Y] Other Genders
Backlogs	Students with backlog(s) not allowed

Hiring Workflow

Screening

No Venue/Time specified

Communication and Aptitude Assessment

No Venue/Time specified

Technical Assessment

No Venue/Time specified

Technical interview

No Venue/Time specified

Statistics

No. of Eligible Candidates	0
----------------------------	---

No. of Participations	0
-----------------------	---

No. of Debarred Students	0
--------------------------	---

Additional Info

No additional information